Polar IceTech: making proof easier to produce

Prepared for Damien McDonnell, Polar IceTech. Private and confidential.

[V] public source, named below [H] hypothesis to test with you [C] to confirm with you. Nothing here is advice or an offer.

What is changing, and how fast

New AI models now arrive every few weeks, and each one changes what AI can do inside a business. Agents plan, use tools, connect to other systems and keep working for hours, acting on company data with real permissions. That asks for the same care around access, testing and oversight that a company gives its own people. Learning has to be continuous too.

What the last few months have shown

The same capability that makes AI useful is making attacks faster and cheaper. Examples as cited in Velocity AI's paper for another client (dated, sourced there; **Cuan has not independently verified them**): AI-assisted research found critical flaws in PHP, the software under most of the web, with a CISA alert on 21 October 2026; the UK National Cyber Security Centre warned on 3 November 2026 that AI now lets attackers strike before organisations have patched; and Chainalysis disclosed on 2 November 2026 that an outside actor used agentic techniques to reach its internal systems.

Three areas every business of this kind should have covered

- **AI capability and continuous learning:** the tools each role needs, owned and measured, with someone who keeps the team learning.
- **Defensibility, systems and resilience:** knowing which AI systems and agents are in use, what each can reach, and how the business keeps running if one fails.
- **Cybersecurity:** protecting networks, systems, supplier connections and connected equipment.

A new model lands at five o'clock, or something happens inside the business at five. What happens at 5:01?

Where Polar IceTech stands, from public sources

- [V] A Cork dry-ice blast cleaning specialist, listed by Cork Chamber as Ireland's leading dry ice blast cleaning specialist with about 20 years in operation; an MTU case study says it was established in 2005 and analyses data before and after the cleaning process [1][2]. [C] The address differs between sources (Ballincollig or Midleton area).
- [V] Damien McDonnell became owner in 2016; the company works in Ireland, the UK and Europe, with customers in manufacturing, pharma, medtech, food and beverage and power generation [3][1]. A job listing describes contract cleaning, machine sales and hire, equipment servicing and industrial vacuum solutions, and a Ruwac distributorship [4].
- [V] Named Best in Class Sustainable Cleaning Company 2024 by the All Ireland Business Foundation [5]. The cleaning uses reclaimed, food-grade CO2 [5].
- [V] It had three employees at a Northern Ireland base in Limavady at the time of the 2017 MTU case study [2]. [C] Current size and whether Limavady is still active.

Part One: your ambition

[C] We have not recorded Damien's own ambition. This section is left for what he tells us: growth targets, sectors he wants more of, and what slows him down.

Part Two: where AI may help, ranked by evidence

1. **Before-and-after job evidence, produced automatically.** [V] Polar IceTech already analyses data before and after cleaning [2]. [H] AI can turn photos and job notes into a clean customer report (what was cleaned, downtime

avoided, water and solvent saved) that pharma and food customers can use in their own audits, and that supports sustainability claims in tenders. Effort: low. This has the strongest link to what the company already does.

2. **Site enquiry to priced scope.** [H] Turn a customer's photos and a short description into a first scope and price the same day. Effort: medium. No evidence yet that quoting is a bottleneck. Test with five recent quotes.
3. **Tender and compliance responses.** [H] Pharma, medtech and food customers ask for method statements, safety documents and sustainability evidence. A library of past jobs and certifications could be used to draft these faster. Effort: medium.
4. **Service and hire scheduling.** [H] Machine hire and servicing [4] suggest recurring work: reminders, consumables reordering (dry ice, nozzles) and service dates, kept in one place. Effort: low to medium.
5. **Finding the next customers.** [H] A target list of Munster pharma, medtech, food and power sites, with the likely cleaning need for each. Effort: low. Fits a business that wins on specialist proof rather than price.

Grant aid to check

- [V] Local Enterprise Office Business Expansion Grant: generally for businesses with 10 or fewer employees; most LEO pages state up to 50% of the investment, capped at 80,000 euro, or 150,000 euro where the business shows it can graduate to Enterprise Ireland; the figures vary by LEO office, so check with the Cork LEO [6]. Eligible costs can include new equipment such as blasting machines, plus consultancy.
- [V] Enterprise Ireland Digital Discovery or GrowDigital: described as up to 80% of costs, capped at about 5,000 euro, for expert help on a first step in AI or digital; amounts vary between sources [7]. [C] Eligibility.

Overall read

Polar IceTech wins on proof: documented results, sustainability credentials and specialist knowledge. The most natural first step for AI is to make that proof faster to produce and easier to show. Start with job reports, then test quoting and tenders.

Sources

1. Cork Chamber member profile: Polar IceTech (https://chamber.corkchamber.ie/list/member/polar-icetech-24689) and demo day event (https://chamber.corkchamber.ie/events/details/exclusive-demo-day-dry-ice-cleaning-in-action-34800)
2. MTU Extended Campus case study (https://extendedcampus.mtu.ie/index.cfm/page/viewCaseStudies?id=377)
3. AIBF podcast Episode 124, Damien McDonnell (https://id.player.fm/1BdeWZx), via search summary
4. Job listings describing services and Ruwac distributorship (jobijoba.ie), via search summary
5. The Echo, Cork business named Best Sustainable Cleaning Company of the Year (https://www.echolive.ie/business/arid-41293345.html); MTU news item (https://extendedcampus.mtu.ie/index.cfm/page/viewNews?id=559)
6. Local Enterprise Office Business Expansion Grant: Kerry LEO (https://www.localenterprise.ie/kerry/financial-supports/business-expansion-grant/); Carlow LEO 2026 form (https://consult.carlow.ie/en/content/local-enterprise-office-application-form-business-expansion-grant-update-2026)
7. Enterprise Ireland Digital Discovery (https://www.enterprise-ireland.com/en/supports/access-advice-digital-discovery); coverage via search results

Cuan read search summaries of these sources, not every page in full. Check figures with the owner before relying on them. Aggregator profiles (RocketReach, village.do) are low reliability and are used only as pointers.

FOR JOHN ONLY. REMOVE THIS PAGE BEFORE ANYTHING IS SHARED.

Approach. Check how well you know Damien. This is a cold or warm approach, so keep it light: one conversation, this brief as an aid, nothing priced. Meridian is not incorporated, so no engagement through it.

Checks before use. Confirm the spelling is McDonnell (confirmed by John), the company's legal name and current address, size, and whether Limavady operates. Re-verify the cyber examples. Shane's agreement on the Stage 1 lead-in wording. Cuan has not seen any evidence Damien wants AI help; every idea above is a hypothesis.

Sensitivity. The previous Stargas approach went quiet after a month. Plan the approach so that one clear touch is followed by a clear stop.

Park rule. Two unanswered touches in 30 days means park for 90 days.